LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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github.com/lvh-data-example

PROFILE

Data engineer with 9 years of experience building batch and streaming data platforms for e-commerce and payments. Designs and operates reliable production data platforms and cloud data warehouses, with strengths in Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, data quality, data contracts and dimensional modelling.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace), Rijeka *03/2022 - present*

- Own the ingestion layer of the company data platform: ~140 Airflow DAGs loading from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and 3rd-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated transformation logic from stored procedures to dbt (420+ models), adding model tests, documentation, incremental models and slim CI with state:modified in GitHub Actions; reduced nightly runtime from 5h10 to 1h35.
- Introduced data contracts between product teams and the data team (JSON Schema + CI checks), cutting broken-pipeline incidents from ~9/month to ~2/month.
- Built a Kafka-based event pipeline using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming for ~30M shipment-tracking events/day, with end-to-end latency under 2 minutes at p95; added dead-letter and replay tooling.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from PostgreSQL with Debezium CDC into Kafka and Snowflake, reducing replica CPU during loads from ~70% to ~25%.
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers; run the weekly data platform office hours.
- Participate in the production data-platform on-call rotation, one week in six.
- Reduced the Snowflake bill from about $38k/month to $24k/month through warehouse sizing and auto-suspend.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay (payments startup), Zagreb *09/2019 - 02/2022*

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile ~1.2 TB/day of S3 files against internal ledgers, reducing finance-team manual reconciliation from ~3 days to ~4 hours per month-end.
- Designed the Redshift cloud data warehouse using dimensional modelling and a star schema, with 30+ fact and dimension tables supporting finance and risk.
- Set up data quality checks with Great Expectations on critical finance tables.
- Wrote internal Python library for S3/Glue catalog access used by 4 teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group, Split *06/2017 - 08/2019*

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL into an on-prem SQL Server warehouse.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations (40+ stores).
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.

SELECTED PROJECTS & OPEN-SOURCE

Open-source contribution — Airflow provider package (2023): fixed a pagination bug and added tests; 2 merged pull requests. Technologies: Python, Airflow, pytest.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University, 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate (May 2024)

SKILLS

Data platform: production data platforms, cloud data warehouses, data contracts, data quality, dimensional modelling, batch and streaming pipelines, CDC.
Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data: Airflow, dbt, Spark (PySpark), Kafka, Kafka Connect, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations

Cloud & infra: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions
BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)